03-14 第2篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why We Cry: The Hidden Job of Tears

① Most people have two strong feelings about crying. One feeling is that crying means we are **weak** — "big boys do not cry", "stop crying like a little child". The other feeling is that crying is just a **waste of water** and a red nose. Science, however, tells a far more interesting story. Tears, it turns out, are one of the oldest and cleverest inventions of the human body.

② First, tears are not all the same. There are **three kinds**. The first is **basic tears**, a thin film that covers our eyes all day long, keeping them moist. The second is **reflex tears**, which suddenly pour out when an onion, a speck of dust or a strong wind attacks our eyes. The third, and the most mysterious, is **emotional tears**, which appear when we are sad, angry, touched or even very happy.

③ Every time we blink, basic tears spread across the eye like a thin, clean river. This river carries away dust, kills simple germs, and feeds the outer skin of the eye with water and salt. Without this quiet flow, our eyes would dry up and hurt in a few minutes. Some elderly people who cannot make enough basic tears have to use eye drops several times a day.

④ Reflex tears work like a little emergency team. When a smoke, a small insect, or a piece of pepper reaches the eye, tear glands send out a quick flood to wash the trouble away. That is why we cry while cutting onions. Interestingly, the **chemical inside** reflex tears is a little different from basic tears — it contains more cleaning materials to fight the danger.

⑤ The most exciting discovery is about **emotional tears**. A team in the United States tested tears from people watching sad films and compared them with reflex tears from the same people. The emotional tears had much higher amounts of **stress hormones** — chemicals that build up in our body when we feel worried. This suggests that when we cry because of strong feelings, our body is actually **washing out** some of the stress. In other words, a good cry can make us feel lighter, and science agrees.

⑥ So, next time tears come to your eyes after a hard test or a silly joke with friends, do not feel ashamed. They are not a sign of weakness. They are a small, clever washing system: cleaning the eye, fighting trouble, and gently carrying away the weight of our feelings. The body does not cry for no reason — it cries to take care of us.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. According to the passage, how many main kinds of tears do humans have?

A. Two.
B. Three.
C. Four.
D. Five.

2. What is the main job of basic tears?

A. To wash onions before cooking.
B. To keep our eyes wet and protect the eye surface.
C. To make our face look clean.
D. To change the colour of our eyes.

3. Why does cutting an onion make us cry?

A. Because onions are sad vegetables.
B. Because our body sends reflex tears to wash the eye.
C. Because our eyes are afraid of the dark.
D. Because onions send out sweet smells.

4. What did the American tear test mainly show?

A. All tears contain the same chemicals.
B. Emotional tears contain higher levels of stress hormones than reflex tears.
C. Reflex tears are useless for health.
D. People should not watch sad films at all.

5. What is the writer's main message?

A. Crying is always a sign of weakness.
B. Crying is a clever body system that helps us in many ways.
C. Children should never watch films.
D. Tears can cure all diseases.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "There are three kinds."
【解析】三种：基础泪、反射泪、情感泪。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B

【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "keeping them moist... feeds the outer skin of the eye"
【解析】基础泪用于保持眼表湿润。A、C、D 无依据。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "That is why we cry while cutting onions"
【解析】切洋葱时泪腺释放反射泪。A、C、D 无依据。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "The emotional tears had much higher amounts of stress hormones"
【解析】情感泪含有更高压力激素。A 与实验结果相反；C、D 属过度推断。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑥段 "a small, clever washing system... it cries to take care of us"
【解析】作者强调哭是身体的聪明系统。A 与文意相反；C、D 偏题。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **hormone** [n.] 激素
- **gland** [n.] 腺体
- **blink** [v.] 眨眼